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Windows Resiliency

Is your WinRE healthy?

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About Martin Himken

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Cloud native Endpoint Management

Certifications

Security MVP Intune

From

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Hobbies

Music listening and scripting

My Blog

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Contact

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Agenda

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What is WinRE?

No, not Win**P**E

What can I do with it?

Does it make ice cream?

Hey, that's my WinRE!

Can we make it make ice cream?

Conclusion

What's next?

Key takeaways:

- **What is WinRE**
- **How to deal with WinRE**

What is WinRE?

No, not Win**P**E

What is WinRE?

- **Win**dows **R**ecovery **E**nvironment
- Has its own partition that:
  - Can’t be encrypted
  - Has a special GUID
  - Hosts the WinRE.wim

Where is it?

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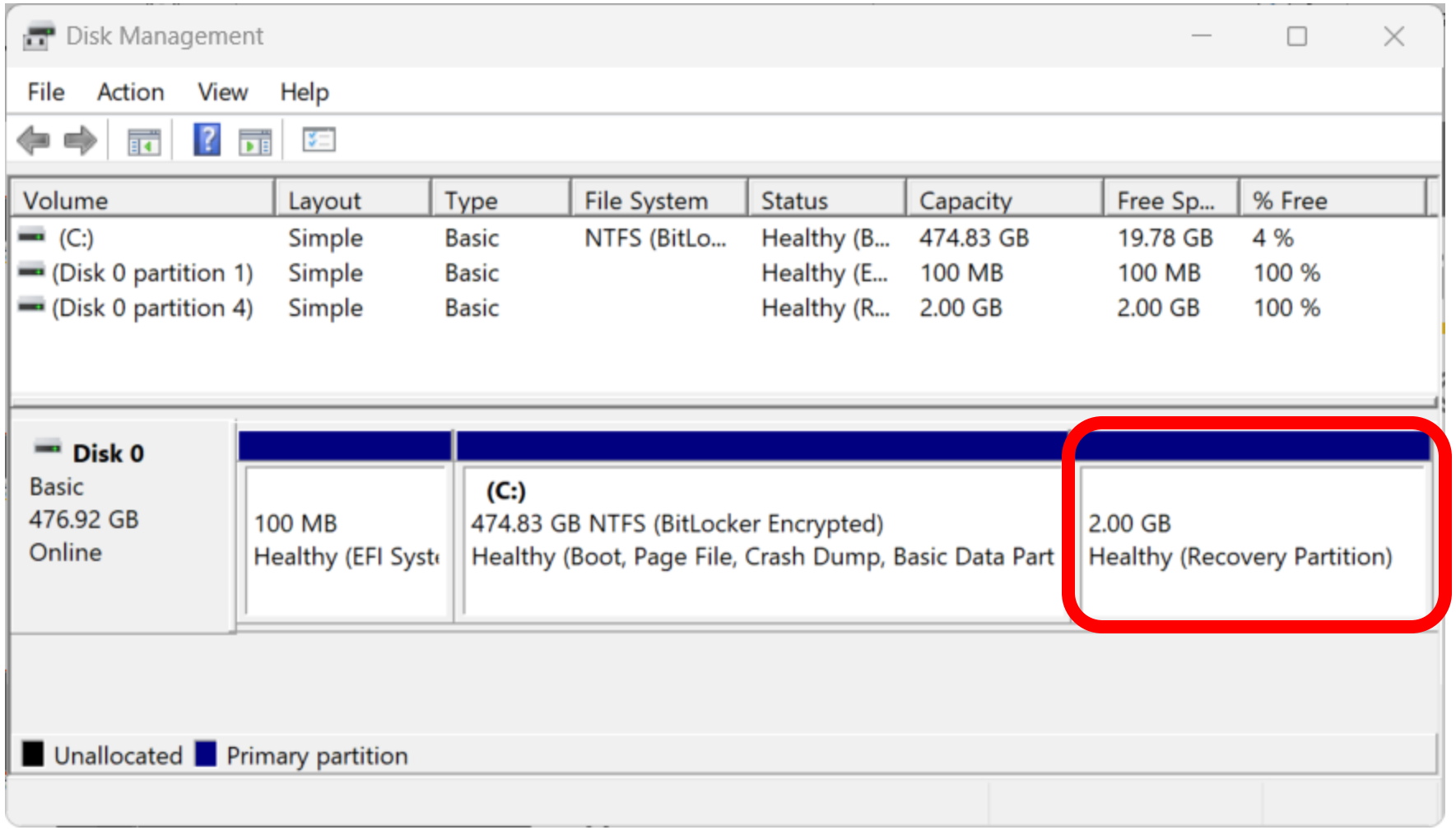

Where (else) is it?

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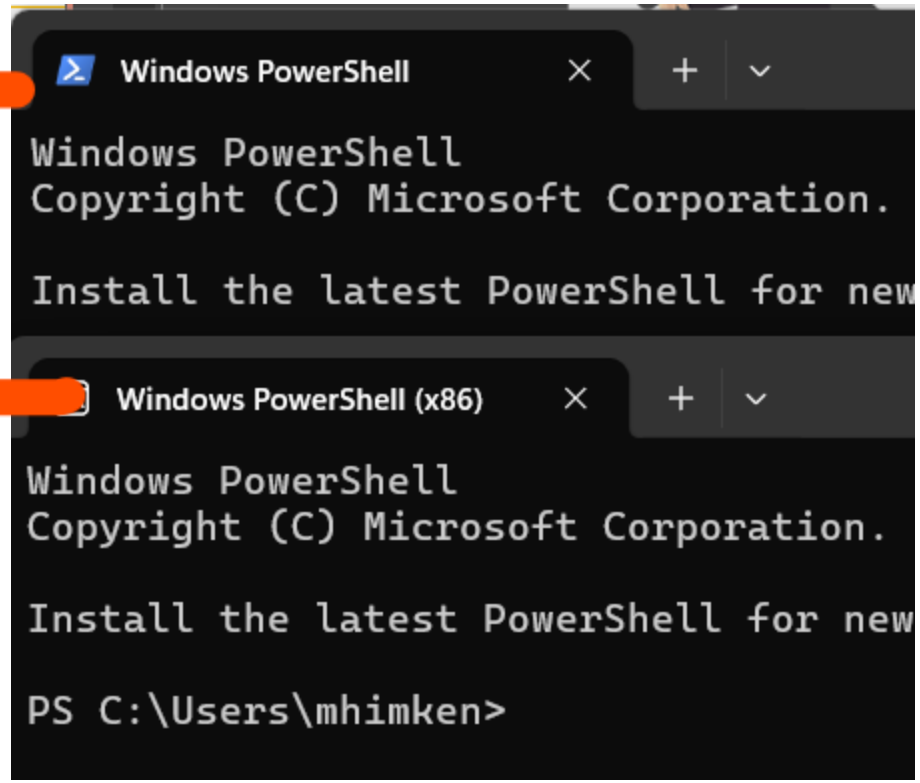
- C:\Windows\System32\Recovery
- C:\Windows\SysWOW64\Recovery …?

- Accompanied by more files… hopefully

Name	Date modified
WifiSettings.ini	21.10.2025 15:17
SrSettings.ini	09.01.2026 23:06
ReAgent_Merged.xml1	10.04.2024 14:24
ReAgent.xml	16.11.2025 01:27

- REagent is *disabled + WinRE.wim*



Size!

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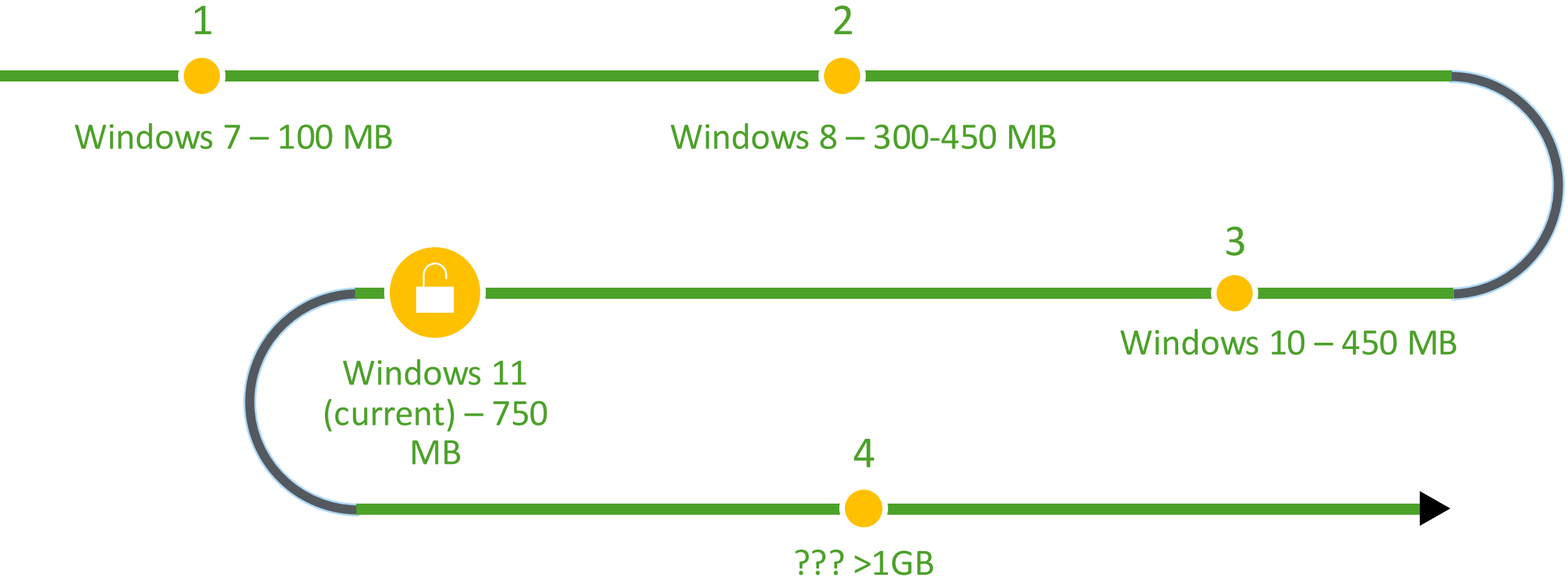

Official Command Switches


```
ReagentC
Configures the Windows Recovery Environment (Windows RE) and system reset.

 /info       - Displays Windows RE and system reset configuration information.
 /setREimage - Sets the location of the custom Windows RE image.
 /enable     - Enables Windows RE.
 /disable    - Disables Windows RE.
 /bootToRE   - Configures the system to start Windows RE next time the system starts up.
```

The Unofficial Fun Stuff


```
/addtrustedapp
/apppath
/auditmode
/autorepair
/bootkey
/boottore
/commit
/configfile
/disable
/discard
/enable
/fix
/gettrustedapps
/hashwimfile
/help
/index
/info
/initiateofflinescanning
/install
/logpath
/migratedrivers
/mountre
/offlinescanningargs
/osguid
/path
/removetrustedapp
/repair
/schedule
/schedulepermanent
/setbootshelllink
/setdownlevelreimage
/setosimage
/setreimage
/target
/uninstall
/unmountre
/validatewim
/validatewimfile
```

What can I do with it?

Does it make ice cream?

What could your WinRE do?

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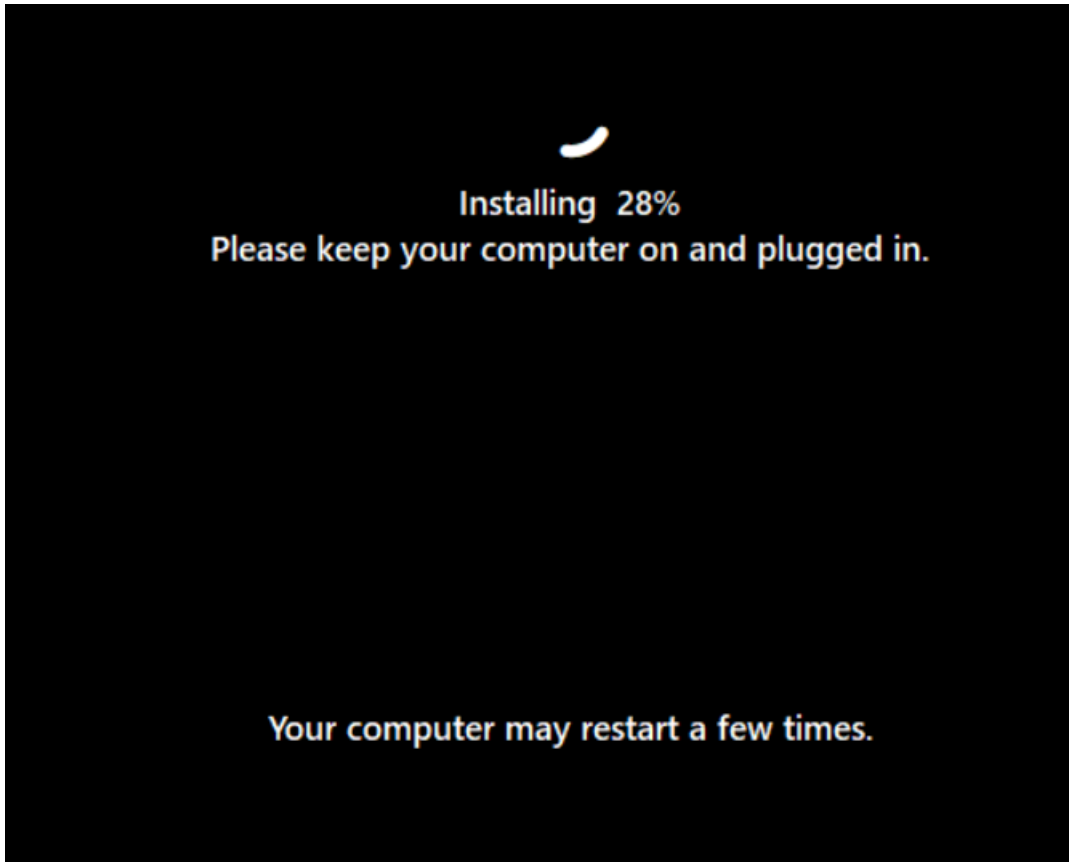
- BitLocker recovery
- Wipe or Fresh Start
- Well… recover!



- Demo

What is WRI?

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1

July 24’
CrowdStrike
Incident

2

Sep 24’
Windows **E**ndpoint **S**ecurity
Ecosystem **S**ummit

3

Safe **D**eployment **P**ractices

The Windows
Resiliency Initiative

4

???
Profit…

The Windows Resiliency Initiative

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(Semi-)Exists now:

Quick Machine Recovery

TBD:

Point-in-time restore (PITR)

Cloud rebuild

Intune Recovery Dashboard

- Enable Cloud Remediation (Windows Insiders only)
  - Enable Auto Remediation (Windows Insiders only)
    - Network Password (Windows Insiders only)
    - Network Password Encryption Store (Windows Insiders only)
    - Network Password Encryption Type (Windows Insiders only)
    - Network SSID (Windows Insiders only)
    - Set Retry Interval (Windows Insiders only)
    - Set Time To Reboot (Windows Insiders only)

Intune Windows Recovery Portal

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Microsoft Intune admin center

Connie Wilson
CONTOSO

Home >

Devices | Windows recovery

Overview | Recovery devices | Remediation scripts | Bare metal recovery | Configuration

Windows recovery

Manage Windows recovery and remediation policies and settings.

Recovery device status

Current	Recent recovery mode
100	1

Remediation action status

Successful	Pending	Failed	Not started
100	0	100	100

WinRE preparedness state

Ready - managed	Pending	Failed	Ready - not managed
15,155	0	57	705

Monitoring reports

Connection Quality Report

Review measures and details of device connection quality and speed. Current and median daily latency measures are available for each device.

Resource performance

Review and compare your current resource's performance scores.

Ignite Session

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https://ignite.microsoft.com/en-US/sessions/BRK345

WRI best practices

Basically “what do you do when”:

1. Business Continuity Planning
2. Have back ups – make sure they work
3. **Ensure Windows Recovery functionality works**
4. Use deployment rings
5. Use Windows security defaults and baselines
6. Adopt a cloud native approach

Ignite Session

https://techcommunity.microsoft.com/blog/windows-itpro-blog/windows-resiliency-best-practices-and-the-path-forward/4201550

Hey, that’s my WinRE!

Can we make it make ice cream?

Hey, that's my WinRE!

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- Make it yours!
- Sometimes you *must* change it
  - Missing drivers
  - Upgraded from W10
  - Installed without in the first place
- Third-Party encryption
- OEM provided images
- Updates (SOS/LCU)

Hey, that's my WinRE!

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- OEMs used to own this space
- They were responsible for the updates
- … they never did anything
- … or did it wrong…
- **You** should own this!

- Demo

Conclusion

What to do next?

Conclusion

- Start learning about WinRE or skill up
- Look out for upcoming features
- Have a backup plan - literally

WinRE Customization script

We love Feedback

Great Session!

Okay Session!

Not so okay Session!

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Thank You